

Blest be the tie that binds

Text: John Fawcett, 1782, alt.

Music: Johann G. Nägeli, 1828; arr. Lowell Mason, 1845

DENNIS SM

The musical score is written for a four-part vocal setting (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) in 3/4 time, key of B-flat major. The melody is primarily in the Soprano part, with harmonization in the other parts. The score is divided into two systems. The first system contains the first four lines of the hymn, and the second system contains the remaining four lines. Chord symbols (I, V7, IV, I7, V) are placed above the Soprano staff to indicate the harmonic structure. The lyrics are printed below the vocal staves, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across measures.

System 1:

I V⁷ I I⁷ IV I V

1 Blest be the tie that binds our hearts in Chris - tian love.
2 We share each oth - er's woes, each oth - er's bur - dens bear,
3 When we a - sun - der part, it gives us in - ward pain,
4 From sor - row, toil, and pain, and sin we shall be free,

System 2:

V⁷ I V V⁷ I IV I IV I V⁷ I

The fel - low - ship of kin - dred minds is like to that a - bove.
and of - ten for each oth - er flows the sym - pa - thiz - ing tear.
but we shall still be joined in heart, and hope to meet a - gain.
and per - fect love and friend-ship reign through all e - ter - ni - ty.